

Indian languages can add 205 million new Internet users

Potential 205 million Internet non-users are likely to go digital if the Internet is provided in a language of their choice—according to a report published jointly by the Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) and Kantar IMRB.

The report estimates 335 million out of the total 481 million Internet users in India are non-unique users in Indic (Sanskrit and its modern Indian descendants), of which 193 million (58 per cent) are from urban India and 141 million (42 per cent) from rural India. The term non-unique

refers to the fact these users do not access the Internet only in Indic; but that only a small proportion of their usage is in Indic.

According to the report, a relatively higher proportion of Indic content consumption can be observed in rural India (76 per cent), while in urban India over 66 per cent Internet users access the Internet in Indic. Indic content consumption is higher in socio-economically weaker sections, as is evident from the fact that both in urban and rural India, SEC D/E have around 80 per cent users accessing Indic content.

As devices spread, voice shopping expected to soar

With voice assistants showing up in more homes and other venues, the voice shopping market will grow from the current \$2 billion a year to \$40 billion by 2022, according to a survey of current device owners by OC&C Strategy Consultants. The survey was conducted on 1500 owners of smart speakers like Google Home and Amazon Echo in the United States.

Artificial intelligence (AI) assistants are spreading to more devices in the home and to environments

like cars and workplaces. In fact, in the next four years, 55 per cent of US households are forecast to have a smart speaker, according to Juniper Research.

Voice shopping is most commonly used for grocery shopping, which makes up 20 per cent of shopping among survey respondents. That's not a complete surprise considering that more than 50 per cent of Amazon Echo speakers are used in the kitchen. Grocery is followed by entertainment (19 per cent), electronics (17 per cent) and clothing (8 per cent).

Philips Lighting introduces LiFi and intends to change company name

Philips Lighting is now offering Light Fidelity (LiFi)—a technology in which high-quality LED lighting provides broadband Internet connection through light waves. With this, it has become the first major lighting company to LiFi-enable regular office luminaires.

"While radio frequencies are becoming congested, the visible light spectrum is an untapped resource with a large bandwidth suitable for stable simultaneous connection of a vast array of Internet of Things devices. Being a lighting company, we ensure

On The Move

Nayyar appointed Sony India's MD

Sunil Nayyar has become the first Indian to be appointed as managing director for Sony India. In this new role, he will be responsible for spearheading the overall growth and profitability of the company within the region. He held the position of sales head from April 2006 till April 2015 prior to moving to Sony North America as head of retail experience, the position which he held from May 2015 till March 2018.

Prof. Mukherji joins Unicom as advisor

IIT Bombay Prof. Soumyo Mukherji has joined Unicom India Ventures as an advisor in Investor Committee. He brings domain expertise in ESDM, bio-engineering and nanotechnology. In the new role, he will guide the team in making investment decisions in ESDM sector, which includes companies working in technologies like robotics, cyber security, IoT, nanotech and medical devices.

BEL wins 4 PRCI awards

Awards

Navratna defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) has won four Corporate Collateral Awards of the Public Relations Council of India (PRCI) for its theme song video, corporate brochure, annual diary and advertisement (hoarding). The awards were presented at the 12th PRCI Global PR Enclave 2018 held at Pune.



BEL corporate communication team comprising Ashish Kansal (sr DGM), Hari Haran (DGM) and Naveen Nambodiri (manager) receiving PRCI Corporate Collateral Awards for BEL from Dilip Kamble, minister of state for Social Justice and Special Assistance, government of Maharashtra